



FROST DATES & SEASON

Last frost: April 5 – April 25
First frost: October 10 – November 1
Season: 170–200 days

THIS MONTH — MAY 2026

1. Tomatoes, peppers & eggplants can go out by late April after 7–10 day hardening off — last frost is early April in most of Zone 6.
2. Direct sow beans and corn after mid-April (soil above 60°F) — Zone 6 is warm enough now.
3. Plant potatoes (if not done in March) and succession-sow lettuce, radishes & arugula for a second spring round before summer heat.

QUICK-START CROPS

Cherokee Purple tomato (H)
72–80 days, signature Zone 6 heirloom. Rich complex flavor, harvests July through October.

Rattlesnake pole bean (H)
65–70 days, drought-tolerant, distinctive purple-streaked pods. Direct sow after mid-April.

Clemson Spineless okra (H)
Zone 6 is warm enough for productive okra. Direct sow after mid-April, harvest July–October.

STORAGE & PRESERVATION

- Two full preservation seasons: early (peas, spring brassicas in June) and main (tomatoes, peppers, beans, corn in Aug–Sept).
- Zone 6's long tomato season (July–Oct) means enough volume to can, ferment hot sauce, and still dry some for winter.
- Fermented pickles (cucumbers, green beans) peak in Zone 6's July harvest window — low equipment, high reward.

ZONE
6

Mid-Atlantic, Ohio Valley,
Central Transition Zone
St. Louis MO · Philadelphia PA · Kansas City MO

HEIRLOOM VARIETY SPOTLIGHT

Cherokee Purple tomato (H)
72–80 days, deeply flavored dark red-purple beefsteak with green shoulders. Zone 6–7 staple.

Rattlesnake pole bean (H)
Named for its markings. Drought-tolerant, 65–70 days, continuous producer if picked regularly.

Wando pea (OP)
The heat-tolerant pea — direct sow March or April, keeps producing into Zone 6's early summer heat.